A Weekend in the Forest

Day 1 · Reading (1 of 2)

What to do: Read it aloud, one paragraph each. Stop at every blue word: can anybody explain it?

Vocabulary topic: Camping, forests and sailing
20 new words (in blue) · EEW 1, Unit 11 · read about camping and the forest and talk about plans and decisions



easy parts harder parts (most new words are here)

Imagine a weekend in the **forest**: tents, a fire, stars and no phone signal. Many people dream about it, but few of them **prepare** well. A good trip starts at home.

Experts say that a camping trip has three important parts: the place, the food and the weather. A good group makes a list. Water, a tent, a warm sleeping bag, matches and a first-aid kit are essential. Then comes an important **decision**: where to put the tent. The **ground** must be flat and dry, and it must not be near a river. A good group is also **serious** about safety and tells a friend where it is going.

In the evening you make a fire. You cook simple food, and you sit and talk. A fire creates a special kind of **conversation**. People forget their phones and tell stories. Many people say that the best talks of their lives happen next to a fire.

The forest is full of life, and it can give you food, but only if you have an expert with you. In late summer, **berries** grow on bushes, and many people **collect** them. But some berries are poisonous, and a wrong decision can be dangerous. The rule is simple: if you cannot identify it, do not eat it. You will not **wake** up happy after a night with a stomachache.

At night the forest sounds **strange**. You hear a branch, an owl, the wind. Every new noise is a story for the imagination. Most of these sounds come from small animals. A **creature** as small as a mouse can make a very big noise in the dark.

A Weekend in the Forest

Day 1 · Reading (2 of 2)

What to do: After reading: which paragraphs were easy, which were hard? Which blue words did you know already?

In some forests there are bigger creatures, so there are special rules: do not keep food in your tent, and make some noise when you walk, so that animals can hear you. Remember: the animal does not want to meet you, and you do not want to meet it, **either**. Stay calm, move away slowly, and never run.

If you prefer water, you can **sail** on a lake. Many young people learn to sail in summer camps. It is not easy at first, but after a week most beginners can **compete** in a small race.

Some people ask: why **spend** a weekend in the cold when you have a warm bed at home? The **truth** is that nature gives us something a house cannot give: silence, a big sky and a clear head. Many people say that they cannot fall **asleep** in the city, but in a tent, after a day of walking, they sleep like a stone.

In your book, Unit 11, a princess falls asleep and wakes up alone in a forest. She meets a strange creature with a pig's nose, but he is kind. Henry **introduces** himself politely. They collect berries, they have a nice day, and in the end they **marry**. Do you know stories like this? Why do we love them?

Here is a simple camp meal: potatoes in the fire. Wrap a potato in paper, put it in the hot ash for forty minutes, and eat it with salt. It is black outside and soft inside, and it tastes better than any restaurant food.

The most important rule of camping is "leave no trace". It means that you take everything back with you: bottles, paper and food. When you leave, the place must look as if nobody was there. The fire must be completely out, and the ashes must be cold. If every visitor follows this rule, the forest stays clean and the creatures stay safe.

After two days without a phone, you do not miss it **anymore**. You listen to the wind and you look at the stars. Try it once. You might be surprised.

The 20 words

Day 1 · Vocabulary table · Topic: Camping, forests and sailing

What to do: Book: 4000 EEW 1, Unit 11, pages 68–71. Copy the words you do not know into the copybook.

Word	Meaning	По-русски	Example
anymore adv.	now, in the present (negative)	больше не	I don't play with toys anymore.
asleep adj.	sleeping	спящий	The baby is asleep.
berry n.	a small soft fruit that grows on a bush	ягода	We picked berries in the forest.
collect v.	bring things together	собирать	My brother collects stamps.
compete v.	try to win against others	соревноваться	Ten teams will compete in the final.
conversation n.	a talk between people	разговор	We had a long conversation on the phone.
creature n.	any living thing, often a strange animal	существо	A dragon is a strange creature.
decision n.	a choice you make	решение	It was a hard decision.
either adv./det.	also (after a negative)	тоже (не); любой из двух	I don't like it either.
forest n.	a large area with many trees	лес	Wolves live in the forest.
ground n.	the surface of the earth	земля	The apple fell to the ground.
introduce v.	tell people each other's names; present	представлять, знакомить	Let me introduce my friend Ali.
marry v.	become husband and wife	жениться, выйти замуж	My cousin is going to marry next month.
prepare v.	get ready	готовить(ся)	We are preparing for the test.
sail v.	travel on water in a boat	плыть (под парусом)	They sailed across the lake.
serious adj.	important; not funny	серьёзный	This is a serious problem.
spend v.	use time or money	тратить; проводить (время)	I spend a lot of time with my friends.
strange adj.	unusual and a bit scary	странный	I heard a strange noise.
truth n.	what is real, not a lie	правда	Please tell me the truth.
wake v.	stop sleeping	просыпаться; будить	I wake up at seven.

More on the topic

Day 1 · Topic: Camping, forests and sailing · more words

What to do: Choose 5 collocations to learn. Use the reserve words when a student already knows the main ones.

Collocations: words that go together

make a decision	принять решение
prepare for a trip	подготовиться к поездке
collect berries	собирать ягоды
compete in a race	участвовать в гонке
have a serious talk	серьёзно поговорить
tell the truth	говорить правду
spend time · spend money	проводить время · тратить деньги
a strange noise	странный шум
fall asleep	заснуть
wake up early	проснуться рано
sail across a lake	плыть под парусом по озеру
introduce yourself	представиться

Phrasal verbs

set up	поставить, установить	We set up the tent near the lake.
put out	потушить	Put out the fire before you leave.
pack up	собрать вещи	We packed up and went home.
head for	направляться в	They headed for the forest.
get lost	заблудиться	Do not get lost in the forest.
look forward to	ждать с нетерпением	I look forward to the trip.

Reserve words: for students who know the 20 already, or if you prefer another word

tent	палатка	**tree**	дерево
campfire	костёр	**path**	тропа
map	карта	**backpack**	рюкзак
compass	компас	**sleeping bag**	спальный мешок
lake	озеро	**flashlight**	фонарик

What to read next · 4000 Essential English Words

This week: **Book 1, Unit 11, “Princess Rose and the Creature”**, pages 68–73. Next: **Unit 12, “The Crazy Artist”**, pages 74–79. About a trip into the unknown: **Unit 2, “The Laboratory”**, pages 14–19.